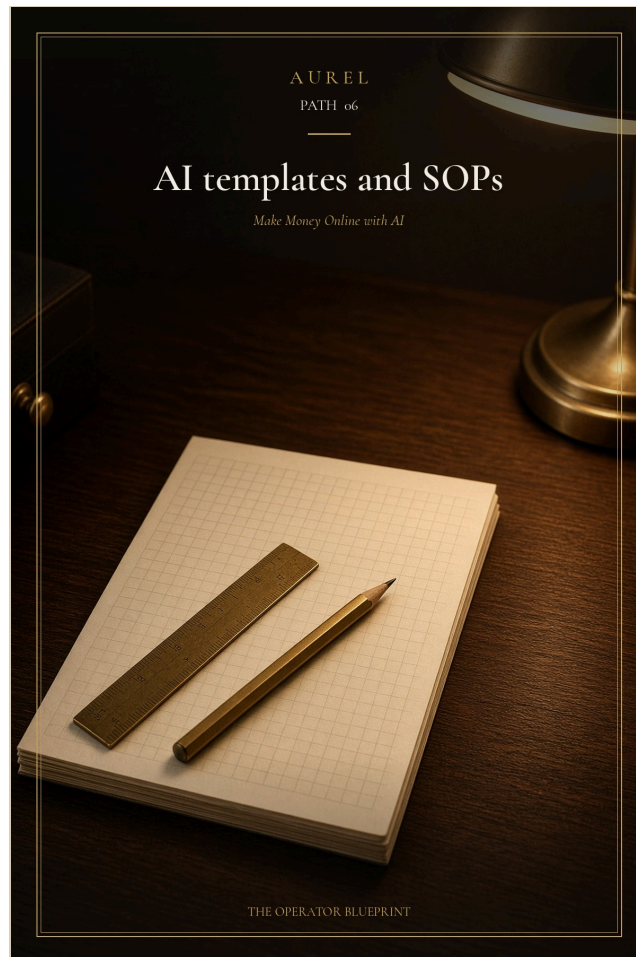




PATH 06

AI templates and SOPs

A filled example sells. An empty grid is homework.

18 minute read · 4,006 words

Who this is for

You already run a repeatable process: intake, content calendar, invoice, weekly review.

Time to first

3–10 days

Tools

First sale

A \$19 template that saves someone an afternoon.

Cash window

\$12–\$29, or \$47 for a bundle of three

Leave this alone

Notion, Google Sheets, Canva, the prompts that generate the filled version.

Empty aesthetic planners. Fifty messy files.

What you are selling

The file is the product. The prompt that fills it is the leverage. Together they let a buyer go from zero to a working system in ten minutes. That is the promise. If it takes an hour of setup, you built software, not a template.

A template in this path is not a pretty empty grid. It is a working example of a job you already do — intake, content calendar, invoice, weekly review — plus the block at the top that rebuilds a filled version from a few inputs. The buyer should be able to duplicate, paste, and move. They should not need a course to sit down.

Why the filled example is the product Show a filled example. A blank Notion dashboard photographs well and converts poorly. People buy the picture of work already done. They do not buy the homework of naming columns. If your listing image is a lavender empty table with cute icons, you are competing with every aesthetic planner on earth, and you will lose on taste.

What this is not It is not an “OS.” It is not a second brain. It is not fifty nested pages. Those words hide a checklist. Call it what it does on a Tuesday: the weekly content calendar, the intake that does not lose notes, the invoice tracker you actually open. If you cannot say the Tuesday problem in one line, you do not have a product yet. You have a file dump.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you already run a repeatable process. You do not need to be a Notion consultant. You need a job you have done more than three times, in a tool you can duplicate without breaking.

You are a fit if You have a calendar, a sheet, or a form you reuse. Other people have asked “can I have that?” You can screenshot a filled week without leaking a client. You are willing to write one prompt that takes a few inputs and returns the filled table, not a poem about productivity.

Skip this path if You only have a blank aesthetic you liked on Pinterest. Empty planners are a crowded street, and you will spend a month on icons. Skip it if your process only lives in your head and has never survived a second week. Skip it if you want to ship fifty messy files and call it a pack. One clean file beats a zip of leftovers.

If you have never kept a calendar for yourself, do not sell one. Use it for two weeks. Then sell the version that has scars: the column you deleted, the status you actually use, the prompt that stopped making twelve posts you would never publish.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write this on a sticky note: “A filled [job] template plus the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes, for [person] who [Tuesday problem]. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.”

Examples that work: a filled weekly content calendar for a one-person shop that never knows what to post. An intake database for a freelancer who loses notes in chat. An invoice tracker for a tradesperson who forgets to send the second bill. The job is in the title. The prompt is in the file. The price is on the button.

The bundle, later A bundle of three related files at \$29 outsells one lonely file at \$12 if they clearly belong together. Calendar plus intake plus weekly review is a week. Calendar plus a mood board plus a habit tracker is a drawer. Related means they share a Tuesday. Unrelated means you are hoping they like your taste.

A \$47 bundle of three is allowed when each file is used, filled, and documented. Do not jump to \$47 because three sounds premium. Jump when a buyer would spend an afternoon without them.

The ten-minute promise If a reasonably tired person cannot get a usable filled week in ten minutes with your how-to open, you overbuilt. Delete tabs until the promise is true.

What ‘done’ looks like

Done is a \$19 template that saves someone an afternoon. Not a library. Not a mobile app. A file they can duplicate today.

The file bar - One Tuesday problem on the cover and in the title -
 A filled example, not an empty grid, in the first screenshot - The AI prompt as a block at the top: inputs in, filled table out - Personal data stripped. Fake names are fine. Real client emails are not -
 A one-page how-to with screenshots. No video required for v1 -
 Works on a phone well enough to read, even if they edit on a laptop

The money bar Checkout works. They get the file. A stranger who is not you can follow the how-to without sending you a voice note. That is done. A three-file bundle at \$29 is a second done, after the first file has been used by someone else.

How to price without guessing

First file: \$19. That is the default. \$12 if the job is tiny (one sheet, ten rows). \$29 if the file is clearly a week of work and the prompt is tested. Do not start at \$79. You have no reviews and a duplicate button.

Why \$19 is the honest first price It is small enough that a tired person will try it to save an afternoon. It is large enough that you will not feel used when they email a question. If you are ashamed of \$19, you either overbuilt or you do not believe the afternoon is real. Cut the file, or use it yourself for another week.

The bundle math One lonely file at \$12 looks cheap and unfinished. Three related files at \$29 look like a week. Chris does this on purpose (see the example): the calendar at \$19, then the three-file bundle at \$29 so the calendar buyer has a next step that is not “buy a course.” A \$47 bundle of three is the later price, when you have proof and a how-to that has been yelled at.

What you do not price You do not charge extra for “lifetime updates” you will not ship. You do not add a \$9 monthly for a template. If they need you every month, that is a service or a membership, not this path.

The first 72 hours

You are not inventing a system from a blank page. You are cleaning the one you already use.

Day 1: duplicate and strip Open the template you already live in. Duplicate it. Strip personal data. Rename the sample person to something obviously fake. Fill one real-looking week so the screenshot has texture: statuses, dates, a note that sounds like work, not “lorem.” Delete every tab you have not opened in fourteen days. Forty tabs is how buyers bounce.

Day 2: the prompt and the how-to Write the prompt that regenerates a filled sample from a few inputs: business, audience, offer, days they can post, voice in one line. Put that prompt in a block at the top of the file. Run it. Paste the output into the filled example. Fix the prompt until the table is usable, not until it is clever.

Write one page of how-to. Screenshots of: duplicate, paste inputs, run prompt, paste results, what “done” looks like. No video required for v1. Export. Screenshot the filled version, not the empty grid.

Day 3: listing and \$19 Price \$19. Title: “Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes.” Put it on your site. Etsy if the search

terms are obvious (content calendar, invoice tracker, client intake). Buy it yourself from a second email. If the file does not arrive, nothing else matters. Then send ten messages to people who have the Tuesday problem.

The path, step by step

Twelve steps. The file comes from a job you already do. Do not reverse that.

Step 1. Name the Tuesday problem “I never know what to post.” “I lose intake notes.” “I forget to invoice.” One sentence. If you need a paragraph, you have two products. Split them.

Step 2. Start from the file you already use Duplicate. Do not rebuild in a new tool because a thread said it was nicer. The scars are in the current file.

Step 3. Build only the columns or pages that solve that Delete the rest. A content calendar needs: date, channel, hook, body, asset, status, link. It does not need a vision board, a reading list, or a sleep tracker.

Step 4. Fill one honest week Use fake names. Keep the texture of real work. This filled week is your listing image and your quality bar.

Step 5. Put the AI prompt at the top Inputs in, filled table out. Include constraints: length, tone, “do not invent offers I did not type.” Run it twice. If the second run is unusable, the prompt is the product to fix, not the colors.

Step 6. One-page how-to with screenshots Duplicate, paste, run, paste, done. Mobile note: which parts are painful on a phone. No video required for v1.

Step 7. Strip, export, name the file like a human “Weekly-content-calendar-filled.html” or a Notion share the buyer owns after duplicate. Not “FINAL_v7_USE_THIS.”

Step 8. Listing on your site. Etsy if the search terms are obvious Title matches the offer sentence. First image is the filled example. Price \$19.

Step 9. Test-buy. Then ten asks Different browser. Confirm they get access. Message ten people who have the Tuesday problem. Not a blast to a group you lurk in.

Step 10. Fix what the first buyer trips on Usually: permissions, a locked database, a prompt that assumes a tool they do not have. Write that into the how-to. Do not add a tab.

Step 11. Week 2: a three-file bundle Only if the files share a Tuesday. \$29. The first file can stay at \$19 for people who only need the calendar.

Step 12. Do not design forty tabs When you want to add a dashboard, go use the file for a week instead. New tabs are how templates become homework again.

Worked example: Chris and the filled calendar

Chris runs a one-person design practice. Every Sunday he used to stare at a blank week and then post nothing until Wednesday. He built a Notion calendar so he would stop staring. Six columns. One view for the week. A status he actually updates. After two months it was ugly and used, which is the only aesthetic that sells.

The \$19 file He duplicated the calendar. He renamed his clients to “River Bakery” and “Lane Tutoring.” He filled one week: five posts, two stories, one email, statuses in plain words (draft, need photo, scheduled). At the top he wrote a prompt:

Paste: what you sell, who it is for, the one offer this month, days you can post, how you sound in one sentence. Return: a seven-day table with date, channel, hook, body under 80 words, asset needed, status set to draft. Do not invent a second offer. Do not sound like a billboard.

He ran it on his own inputs. He edited two hooks that were cute and useless. He put that filled week in the first screenshot. Title: “Filled weekly content-calendar (Notion) + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes.” \$19. How-to: one page, five screenshots. No video.

The first sales He sent it to eight people who had complained about posting. Three bought in a week. One asked where to put intake notes. That question is how the bundle starts. It is not a reason to add a tab to the calendar.

The \$29 three-file bundle Week 2 he cleaned two other files he already used: a client intake (so notes stop dying in chat) and a Friday weekly review (what shipped, what slipped, what to put in next week’s prompt). Same treatment: filled example, prompt at the top, one-page how-to. Bundle of three at \$29. The calendar stayed available alone at \$19. People who only wanted posts could stay small. People who wanted the week bought the bundle.

Chris did not call it an OS. He did not add a CRM. He did not film a twenty-minute walkthrough for v1. He sold the picture of a week already done, and the prompt that rebuilds it.

Copy you can paste

Swap the job. Keep the filled promise.

Listing title Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes.

Listing first line You get a filled week, not an empty grid.

Duplicate the Notion (or sheet). Paste a few inputs. Run the prompt. Paste the table. About ten minutes. \$19.

Post under a screenshot of the filled example This is last week’s calendar, names changed. Empty templates are homework. This one is already working. \$19, link in bio. The prompt that rebuilds it sits at the top of the file.

DM I use this every Sunday so I stop staring at a blank week.
 Filled [job] template plus the prompt that rebuilds it. \$19. If
 that saves you an afternoon: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Bundle line Three files that share a Tuesday: weekly calendar, intake, Friday
 review. \$29. Each one has a filled example and the prompt that rebuilds it.

What not to write “Aesthetic Notion dashboard for CEOs.”
 “Ultimate content OS.” “200+ templates.” Those lines sell a vibe to
 people who will not open the file. You are selling an afternoon back.

Week-by-week

You can do the first sale inside ten days if the file already exists. Do not use week one to learn a
 new tool.

Days 1–2: clean the file you already use Duplicate. Strip. Fill one week. Write the
 prompt. Run it. Fix it. Draft the one-page how-to. Screenshot the filled version.

Day 3: listing \$title, \$19, filled screenshot first, test-buy, ten
 asks. Etsy only if someone would search the job by name.

Days 4–7: silence is data If nobody buys, ask two of the ten what was unclear.
 Usually the title is vague or the screenshot is empty. Fix those. Do not add a tab.

Week 2: a three-file bundle Only related files. \$29. Keep the single at \$19. Do
 not design forty tabs. Do not start a fourth file because bundling felt good.

Weeks 3–4 Use your own file in public: one post that shows this
 week’s filled row (blur what you must). Answer the two questions
 buyers actually ask. Update the how-to. That is the whole month.

The quality bar

A stranger should go from purchase to a filled week in ten minutes without you. That is the bar. Pretty is optional. Clear is not.

The filled-week test Hand the how-to to someone who has not seen the file. Time them. If they need you at minute four, the how-to is missing a screenshot. If they need you at minute twenty because of a nested relation, you built software. Flatten it.

The mobile test Open the file on a phone. Can they read the week? Can they see the prompt? Editing on a phone can be ugly. Reading should not be. Forgetting mobile is how you lose the people who buy at 10 p.m. on a couch.

The prompt test Run the prompt on two different businesses. If both outputs look like the same billboard, add constraints: offer they typed, words they use, length. The prompt is part of the product. A cute template with a lazy prompt is an empty grid with extra steps.

Naming Call it a checklist or a calendar if that is what it is. Calling it an OS when it is a checklist trains buyers to expect a product you did not make, then to leave a review that says so.

What to count

Count a short list for the first twenty sales.

Count these - Sales of the \$19 file. First sale from someone who is not you is the milestone. - Refunds and “I can’t open this” notes. Those are how-to bugs, not personality flaws. - Time-to-filled-week from the one person you watch. Aim under ten minutes. - Bundle attach: how many \$19 buyers take the \$29 three-file set. If none do, the extra files are not related, or you never said they share a

Tuesday. - Which screenshot they linger on, if your host shows it. It should be the filled example.

Ignore these for now Likes on a template aesthetic post. Number of tabs as a flex. A competitor with 4.8 stars and two hundred files. You are not in a volume contest. You are in an afternoon-saving contest.

If you have three sales and zero open tickets, you are fine. If you have thirty views and zero sales, the screenshot is empty or the title hides the job. Fix the listing before you rebuild the file.

Objections you will hear

“Notion templates are everywhere and cheap.” Empty ones are. Filled ones with a prompt that rebuilds the week are not everywhere. Compete on the Tuesday problem and the example, not on pastel.

“People will just copy the structure.” They will. The prompt, the filled week, and the how-to still save an afternoon. You are selling time, not a secret column name.

“I should record a course first.” No. One-page how-to. Screenshots. No video required for v1. A course is a different path and a longer delay. If they cannot sit down without a forty-minute video, the file is too clever.

“\$19 feels too low.” Good. Sell ten. Then offer the \$29 bundle. Then, with proof, a \$47 set of three that is actually used. Pride is not a price.

“What if they want it in a different tool?” Pick Notion or Google Sheets or Canva — the one you already use. A second version is a second product. Mention the tool in the title so they do not buy the wrong one.

“I do not have three files.” Then sell one at \$19. The bundle is week 2, not a requirement for week 1. A single honest file beats a padded zip.

What this path feeds

A template is a thin product that throws off thicker ones.

What it fills The letter can show this week’s filled row and link the \$19 file. The playbook can include the template as the working file at the back. People who write “can you just fill this for me?” are asking for a productized package, not a free hour. Send the price or send the file. Do not hop on a call that becomes the job.

What it needs It needs a Tuesday problem you have already solved in a tool you control. It does not need a membership to “get all templates.” Fifty messy files is the thing to leave alone. One file that works, then a bundle of three that belong together.

Mistakes that stall this path

Aesthetic, tabs, and homework Competing only on aesthetic. Taste is not a Tuesday problem. A filled ugly calendar will outsell an empty beautiful one.

Shipping 40 tabs. Each tab is a place to get lost. Delete until the how-to fits on one page.

Forgetting mobile. If the week cannot be read on a phone, a lot of your buyers will bounce after they pay, which is the worst bounce.

No example. An empty grid is homework. People do not buy homework when they are already tired.

Naming and the zip of leftovers Calling it an “OS” when it is a checklist. You will attract buyers who want a company, and they will

tell you your checklist is incomplete. They are right about the naming.

Also: fifty messy files in a zip. A prompt that generates fluff. Listing photos of mockups with no real rows. Hiding the tool name so both Notion people and sheet people are annoyed. Locking the database so duplicate does nothing. Those are how \$19 turns into a refund.

Tools (the ones you already use)

Notion, Google Sheets, Canva, and the prompts that generate the filled version. Pick the tool the job already lives in.

Notion Good for calendars, intakes, and reviews with a few views. Bad when you nest five relations and call it simple. Duplicate must work. Permissions must not block the buyer.

Google Sheets Good for invoices, trackers, and anything that wants a sum. Put the prompt in row 1 as a note, or on a tab named HOW-TO so it cannot be missed. Filled example on the first tab.

Canva Good when the deliverable is a thing they will post or print: a carousel, a one-pager, a simple invoice. Still show a filled example. An empty brand kit is another aesthetic trap.

The prompt Lives in the file. Inputs in, filled table out. Tested on two businesses. This is not a separate course. It is a block at the top.

Leave empty aesthetic planners and fifty messy files on the shelf. You already know they do not save an afternoon.

Checklist

Tick this before you raise the price.

File - Tuesday problem in one line - Duplicated from a file you actually use - Personal data stripped - One filled week with fake names and real texture - Extra tabs deleted - Prompt at the top: inputs, output format, constraints - Prompt run twice on different inputs - One-page how-to with screenshots - Readable on a phone

Listing - Title: Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes - First image is the filled example, not the empty grid - Tool named (Notion, Sheets, or Canva) - Price \$19 (or \$12 if truly tiny) - Test-buy from a second email - Ten personal asks

Week 2 (optional) - Two more related files, same treatment - Bundle \$29 (or \$47 when each file is proven) - Single file still for sale

FAQ

Do I need to be a Notion expert? No. You need a file you already use. If you cannot duplicate it without breaking, simplify until you can. Expertise is not the product. The afternoon saved is.

Can I sell on Etsy only? Sell on your site first so you own the buyer. Etsy if the search terms are obvious: content calendar, invoice tracker, client intake. Title like a search, not like a brand poem.

Should I include a video? Not for v1. One-page how-to. Screenshots. If ten buyers ask the same question, add one short clip of that step. Do not film a course to avoid writing a page.

What if my process lives in three tools? Sell the one that hurts on Tuesday. Mention the others in the how-to as optional. A three-tool setup is how ten minutes becomes an hour.

Is \$29 too cheap for three files? Not if they share a Tuesday and each has a filled example. Chris's bundle is \$29 on purpose. \$47 is later, with proof. Cheap is fifty messy files. Related and filled is the value.

Can I use AI to build the template itself? You can draft columns. You still have to live in the file for a week. A model will give you twenty tabs. You need six.

What license do they get? Personal use, duplicate for their work, no resale of the template as a template. Say that in one paragraph on the how-to. You are not launching a legal department.

Someone wants custom columns. That is a service. Quote a package or say no. Do not turn \$19 into an unpaid rebuild.

The buyer says the prompt is generic. It is. Fix it with their inputs as required fields and a constraint list. Update the file. Send them the new prompt. That update is worth more than a new tab.

When do I make a second product? After the first file has a stranger sale and a how-to that no longer gets the same question. Then a related file, then a \$29 bundle. Not a 50-file vault.